

The Job Submission Workbook

Everything your assistant needs to run the AI QS portal on your behalf: how to get her own login, how to send a set of drawings in so it comes back as a priced BOQ, and what to do when it doesn't go to plan.

WRITTEN FOR

The VA · the account owner

COVERS

Access, submission, tracking, delivery

SHEETS

24 · press 

Drawings in, priced BOQ out

The portal is a one-way conveyor with a QS team at the far end. Your assistant's whole job lives in the first step — get a complete, well-described set of drawings onto the belt. Everything after that happens without her.

STEP 01

She submits

Project type, site address, the drawing files, and a written brief. One BOQ credit is spent at this moment.

STEP 02

The QS team prices it

Typically back within 24 hours as a Bill of Quantities plus a Findings Report. Nobody needs to chase.

STEP 03

You make it yours

Amend the numbers, then produce a Client Copy carrying your own logo and colours to send on.

THE FIVE STATES EVERY JOB PASSES THROUGH

01	02	03	04	05
Submitted	In Review	Being Priced	Completed	Delivered
On the QS team's desk. Nothing for you to do.	A surveyor has opened it and is reading the brief.	The BOQ and Findings Report are being produced.	Priced and checked, about to land in your portal.	Documents are in My Projects, ready to download.

What's on each sheet

Click any line to jump. Section B is a one-off setup you do once, together. Section C is the part she'll repeat every time — that's the section to keep open on her second screen.

A • ORIENTATION

02	Drawings in, priced BOQ out	03	What's on each sheet
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B • HER ACCOUNT

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C • SUBMITTING

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Two ways to give her access

The portal supports both. They behave very differently, and only one of them is right for a VA working on your jobs.

USE THIS ONE • AUTHORIZED SIGN-IN EMAIL

She joins *your* account

She signs in with her own email and her own password — you never share yours. Once in, she is looking at your account: your jobs, your credits, your rates, your branding.

- ✓ Her submissions land in your My Projects, where you'd expect them
- ✓ Spends your credit pool — no separate balance to top up
- ✓ Remove her access in one click when the engagement ends
- ✓ Nothing to re-explain: it's the same portal you already use

NOT FOR A VA • SEPARATE USER ACCOUNT

She gets her own account

A completely independent account with its own login, its own credits, its own project list and its own rate library.

- ✗ Her jobs are invisible from your account — and yours from hers
- ✗ Needs its own BOQ credits bought and topped up separately
- ✗ Rates and branding start empty and must be set up again
- ✗ Right for a second company, wrong for an assistant

ONE-WAY DOOR

An email can be one or the other, never both. Once `va@yourcompany.co.uk` has its own portal account, the portal refuses to add it as an authorized email on yours. Decide before you create anything.

Adding her to your account

01 Sign in as an AI QS admin

Only an admin can do this — the button doesn't exist on a customer login. If you're not an admin, send AI QS support her name and email and ask them to authorize it against your account.

02 Open Users in the sidebar

The admin-only user list. Every account on the portal is here.

03 Find your account row, click Manage

The row expands into the management panel for that account.

04 Scroll to Authorized Sign-in Emails

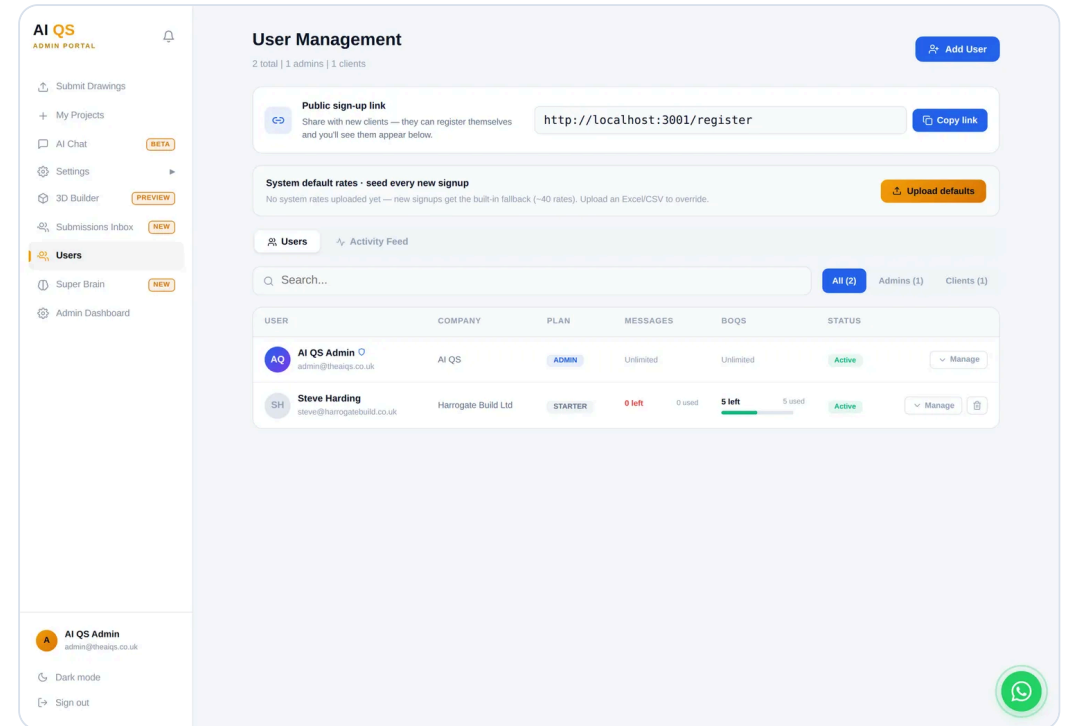
Near the bottom, under Rate Library.

05 Type her email and name, click Authorize & Invite

Use her real working email — it becomes her username, and it's where the invite goes.

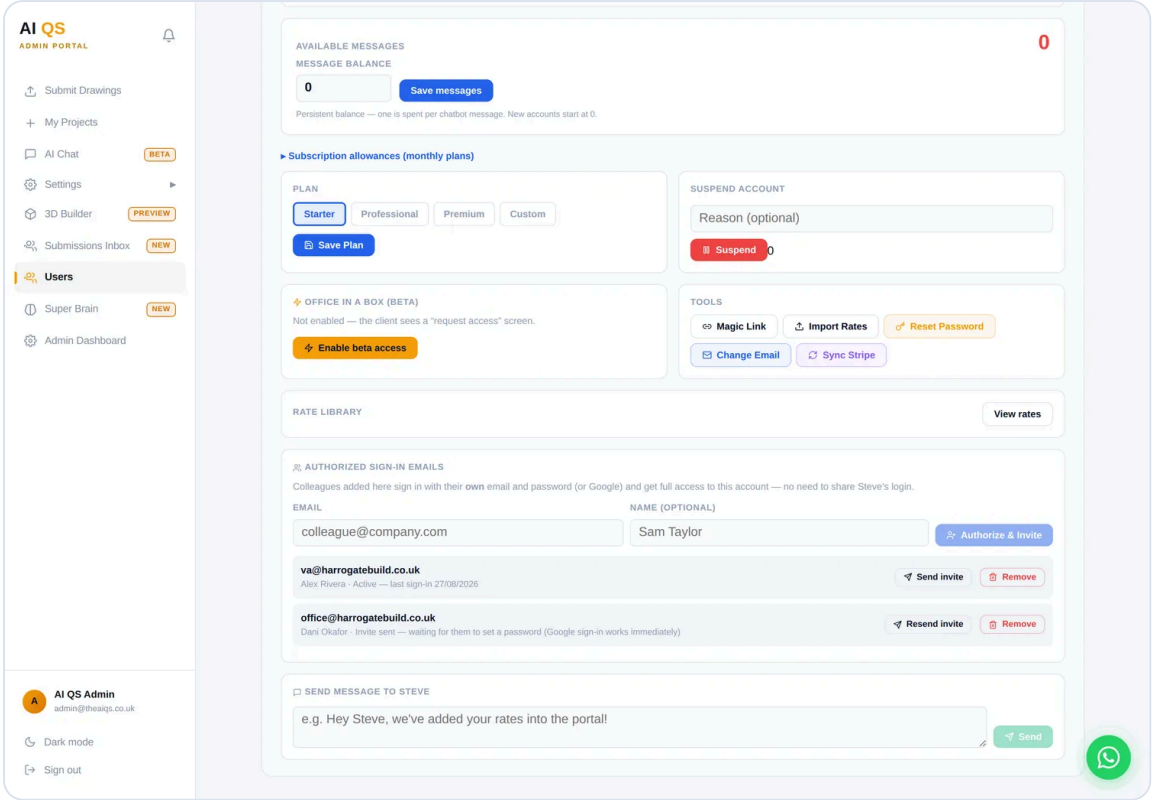
IF NO EMAIL ARRIVES

When the portal can't send mail it shows the invite link on screen instead. Click it to copy, then send it to her yourself by WhatsApp or however you normally reach her.



SHEET 05A Users → your row → **Manage**. The row expands downward into the panel shown on the next sheet.

Authorized Sign-in Emails



SHEET 06A Two states side by side: **Alex Rivera** has set a password and is active; **Dani Okafor** has been invited but hasn't set one yet.

ACTIVE

Active — last sign-in She's set her password and is using the portal. The date tells you when she was last in.

WAITING

Invite sent The email has gone but she hasn't set a password. **Resend invite** issues a fresh link — the old one dies.

ENDING ACCESS

Remove Cuts her off immediately and permanently. Her past submissions stay in your account — only the login goes.

Setting her password

01 She opens the invite link

From the email, or whatever you sent her. It lands on the screen opposite, already naming your company so she knows she's in the right place.

02 She picks a password

Minimum eight characters. It's hers — you never see it and never need it.

03 She clicks Set Password & Sign In

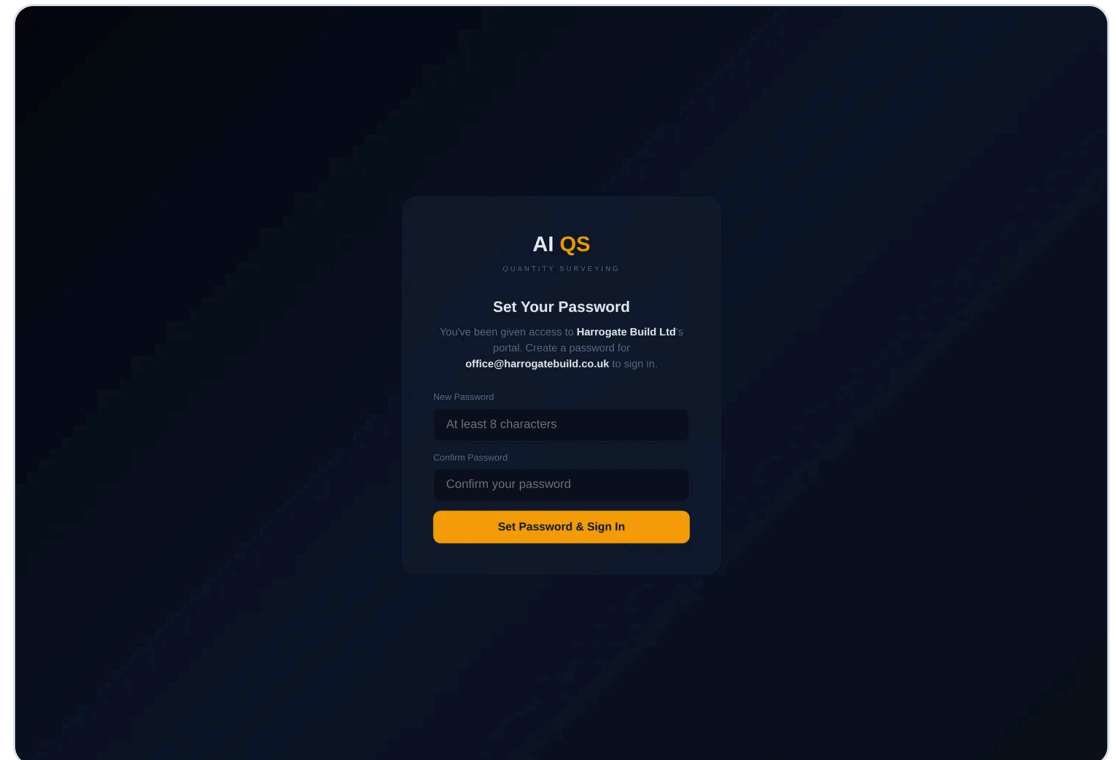
That signs her straight in. No second confirmation step, no waiting on you.

THE LINK EXPIRES IN 7 DAYS

If she leaves it too long the page says so. Go back to the panel and click **Resend invite** — it mints a new 7-day link.

GOOGLE IS A SHORTCUT

If her email is a Google account she can skip the invite entirely and use **Sign in with Google** from the login page the moment she's been authorized.



SHEET 07A The company name in the sentence is the check that the invite is genuine and pointed at the right account.

What she can see and do

She's inside your account, not beside it. Be deliberate about this — it's the whole trade-off of the delegate model.

SHE HAS

- ✓ Full access to submit jobs and spend your BOQ credits
- ✓ Every job in My Projects, past and present, with all downloads
- ✓ Your rate library, AI memory and branding settings — editable
- ✓ The AI Chat, which spends message credits when used

SHE DOES NOT HAVE

- ✗ Any admin screens — no Users list, no other customers' work
- ✗ A separate credit pool: every job she sends spends yours
- ✗ The ability to add further authorized emails herself
- ✗ Your password — and she never needs it

THE THING THAT CONFUSES EVERYONE

Once she's signed in, the sidebar shows **your** name and email at the bottom, not hers — because she's operating your account. That's correct and expected. The screenshots in Section C were all taken while signed in as the VA, and they say *Steve Harding* at the bottom left for exactly this reason.

Creating a fully separate account

Use this when the person genuinely needs their own walled-off account — a second company, a different client, a colleague whose jobs must not mix with yours. **Not for a VA submitting your work.**

01 Users → Add User

Top right of the admin Users page.

02 Fill in name, email, company

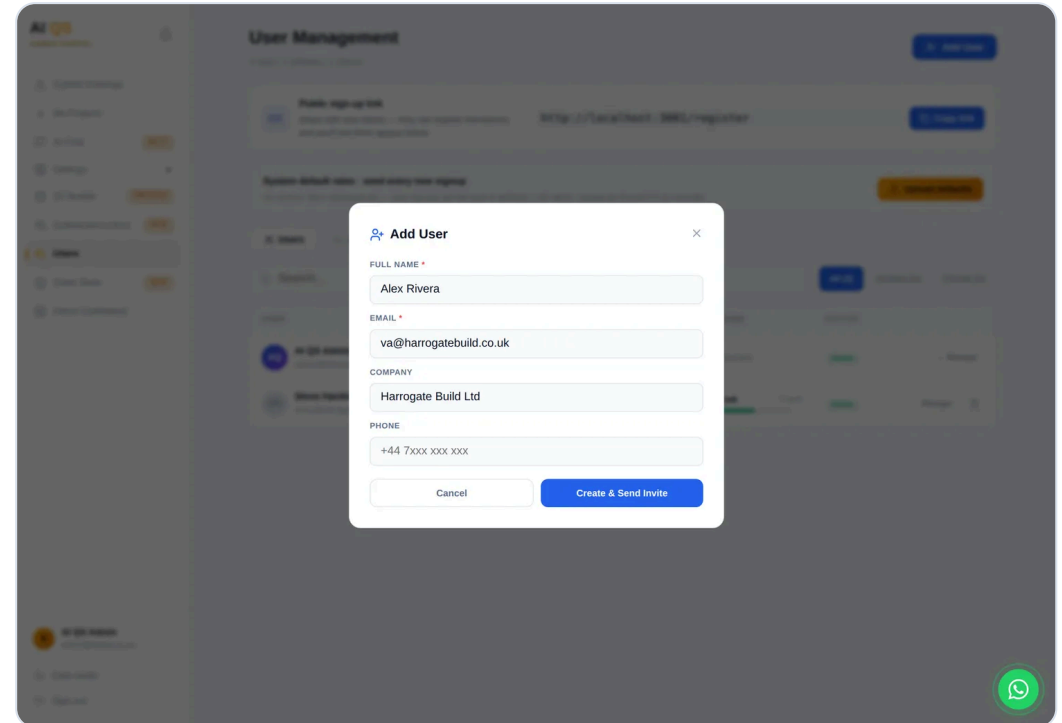
Role stays *client* unless you're deliberately making another admin.

03 Create & Send Invite

They get a welcome email with a 7-day link to set their own password. If mail isn't configured the link is copied to your clipboard instead.

04 Give them credits

A new account starts at zero BOQ credits. Set a balance in the same Manage panel, or they can't submit anything.



SHEET 09A Remember: this email can then never be added as an authorized email on your account.

Have these four things ready

Every failed submission traces back to one of these being missing. Two minutes of gathering saves a re-do — and a wasted credit if the brief was too thin to price properly.

01 • THE DRAWINGS

Plans, elevations, sections, and any structural sheets. **PDF is best** — the pipeline reads the dimensions and schedules straight off a vector PDF rather than eyeballing a picture. For CAD, export **DXF**; a DWG should be saved out as DXF or PDF first.

02 • THE SITE ADDRESS

A full postal address including the postcode. It isn't filing detail — the pricing applies regional labour and material factors, so the postcode moves the numbers.

03 • THE BRIEF

What's being built, in words. If the client sent it by email or WhatsApp, have that text open and ready to paste. See sheet 14 for what a good one looks like.

04 • A CREDIT

One BOQ credit per submission. The banner at the top of the form shows the balance. At zero the form stops and offers a top-up instead.

Max 20 files per job

Max 100 MB per file

PDF • DXF • DWG • JPG • PNG • DOCX • XLSX

Brief: 20 characters minimum

Open Submit Drawings

It's the first item in the sidebar, and it's where she'll start every single time. The whole submission is one page — there are no wizard steps to get lost in.

CHECK THE CREDIT BANNER FIRST

The strip under the three cards shows what's left: *"7 BOQ credits remaining"*. If it's red and says zero, stop and top up — the form won't send.

WHAT THE PAGE IS TELLING HER

- ✓ The three cards across the top restate the loop: submit → delivered to the portal → make it yours
- ✓ Everything with an amber * is required; the form won't submit without all four
- ✓ The Terms tick at the bottom is a hard gate, not a formality

SHEET 11A The form on open, with seven credits in the bank.

Project type, then site address

Project Type

Pick the closest match from the list. It sets which trades and rate families the QS starts from, so a wrong pick makes for a slower job.

Residential Extension Loft Conversion Full Refurbishment

New Build Commercial Fit-Out Demolition / Enabling Works

Heritage / Listed Building Structural Steelwork

Metalwork / Fabrication Other

Nothing fits? Choose **Other** and say what it is in the first line of the brief. Don't force a bad match.

Site Address

The address of the works — not your office, not the client's home if the job is elsewhere.

GOOD 14 Mill Lane, Harrogate, HG1 2AB

BAD Harrogate job

Always include the postcode. Pricing is adjusted by region across dozens of UK location factors, and the postcode is what drives that.

HOUSEKEEPING

The site address is the one field that stays filled in after a successful send. If she's submitting a second, different job straight after, overwrite it — don't let the last job's address ride along.

Attaching the drawings

Two ways in, and they do the same thing: click **Choose files** and multi-select, or drag the whole set onto the dashed panel underneath.

- ✓ Each file appears as a row with its size — check the list matches what she meant to send
- ✓ Wrong file? The ✕ on its row removes it before sending
- ✓ Selecting more files adds to the list, it doesn't replace it
- ✓ Send the whole set in one go — a second submission costs a second credit

SEND MORE, NOT LESS

Elevations, sections, structural sheets and finishes schedules all make the BOQ better. A plan on its own is the most common cause of a thin, caveated quote.

WHILE IT'S UPLOADING

Don't close the tab or hit back. Large sets take a minute, and the browser will warn her if she tries to leave mid-upload.

AI QS
CLIENT PORTAL

Submit Drawings

My Projects

AI Chat

AI Trades Pilot

Settings

Site Address *

14 Mill Lane, Harrogate, HG1 2AB

Drawings & Documents *

Choose files

PDF, DWG, images, Word, Excel

...or drag & drop drawings here

proposed-plans.pdf
1.6 KB

elevations.pdf
1.6 KB

structural-S-101.pdf
1.6 KB

finishes-schedule.xlsx
6.6 KB

Project Details *

Single-storey rear extension, 5.2m x 3.8m internal. Cavity wall in facing brick to match existing, 100mm PIR insulation, pitched tiled roof at 30 degrees. Bifold doors 3.0m wide to the garden elevation. New steel beam over the opening into the existing kitchen (see structural sheet S-101). Screed and underfloor heating to the extension floor. Full specification is on the drawings.

Enhance my writing with AI FREE

☒ I've read and agree to the [Terms & Conditions](#) and [Privacy Policy](#) — including that AI-generated documents are estimates which I must check and verify before relying on them.

Submit Enquiry →

Steve Harding
steve@harrogatebuild.co.uk

Dark mode

Sign out

SHEET 13A A complete, ready-to-send job: four files listed, a specific brief, Terms ticked.

Writing the brief

The minimum is twenty characters. The minimum is also useless. This box is the difference between a BOQ you can send to a client and one that comes back full of assumptions.

TOO THIN – EXPECT CAVEATS

“Extension at the back, see drawings.”

Passes the character count. Tells the surveyor nothing the drawings don't already have to prove on their own, so anything ambiguous gets priced conservatively.

WHAT TO AIM FOR

“Single-storey rear extension, 5.2m × 3.8m internal. Cavity wall in facing brick to match existing, 100mm PIR insulation, pitched tiled roof at 30 degrees. Bifold doors 3.0m wide to the garden elevation. New steel beam over the opening into the existing kitchen (see structural sheet S-101). Screed and underfloor heating to the extension floor.”

Dimensions, materials, specification, and a pointer to the sheet that proves the tricky bit.

HER CHECKLIST FOR THIS BOX

- Sizes.** Overall dimensions and storey heights, even where they're on the drawings.
- Materials.** Brick, render, roof covering, floor finishes, glazing — anything chosen.
- Awkward bits.** Steels, underpinning, party walls, restricted access, phasing, demolition.

Enhance my writing with AI

WHAT IT DOES

- ✓ Tidies grammar, punctuation and structure
- ✓ Turns a rushed WhatsApp paste into something a surveyor can read quickly
- ✓ Free — it doesn't cost a BOQ credit
- ✓ Takes about ten seconds and replaces the text in the box

WHAT IT DOES NOT DO

- ✗ Add facts. It cannot invent dimensions, materials or specs
- ✗ Rescue a thin brief — polished vagueness is still vague
- ✗ Work under 10 characters typed
- ✗ Ask permission before overwriting; the original text is gone

HOUSE RULE

Write the full brief first, then polish. Never polish first and hope it fills the gaps — and if the client's exact wording matters (a specified product, a named finish), read the polished version back before sending.

Terms, then Submit Enquiry

01 Tick the Terms box

It confirms that AI-generated documents are estimates to be checked before they're relied on. The submission is refused without it — this is enforced on the server, not just hidden in the page.

02 Click Submit Enquiry

The button stays greyed until project type, address, files, a 20-character brief and the tick are all present.

03 Wait — don't touch anything

The label walks through “Uploading...”, “Sending to our QS team...”, “Almost there...”. A big set can take a minute.

04 Read the green confirmation

It carries the Submission ID. That ID is the reference for any query about this job.

The screenshot shows the AI QS Client Portal interface. On the left is a sidebar with navigation links: 'Submit Drawings' (active), 'My Projects', 'AI Chat' (marked BETA), 'AI Trades Pilot' (marked NEW), and 'Settings'. The main content area is titled '4 BOQ credits remaining (used 2)'. It contains a form with the following sections:

- Project Type ***: A dropdown menu with 'Select a project type...'.
- Site Address ***: A text input field containing '14 Mill Lane, Harrogate, HG1 2AB'.
- Drawings & Documents ***: A section with a 'Choose files' button and a dashed box for dragging/dropping drawings. It also lists supported file types: PDF, DWG, images, Word, Excel.
- Project Details ***: A text area with a character count of 0. The placeholder text reads: 'Describe your project: rooms, dimensions, materials, specifications, location, anything on the drawings. The more detail you add, the more accurate your BOQ will be.'

Below the form, there is a purple button 'Enhance my writing with AI FREE', a checkbox 'I've read and agree to the Terms & Conditions and Privacy Policy' (checked), and a large orange 'Submit Enquiry' button. At the bottom, a green confirmation banner displays the submission ID: 'sub_1787825381052_jg0zu'. A user profile for 'Steve Harding' is visible in the bottom left corner of the sidebar.

SHEET 16A Sent. Note the banner at the top has ticked down to **4 credits**.

ASK HER TO DO THIS EVERY TIME

Copy the Submission ID into your job sheet or CRM the moment it appears. It's the fastest way to find a job later, and the only reference support will ask for.

Submitting from a phone

The whole form works on a phone — same fields, same rules, stacked into one column with the sidebar behind the menu button. Useful when drawings arrive by email on the move.

- ✓ **Files come from wherever the phone can reach** — Files, Photos, Drive, Dropbox, or straight from the camera
- ✓ **Photographing paper drawings works**, but flat, square-on and in good light, and it will never price as well as a PDF
- ✓ **Stay on the tab while it uploads.** Switching apps mid-upload on a phone is the most common cause of a failed send
- ✓ **Prefer wi-fi** for a large set — a 100 MB sheet over mobile data is slow and easy to interrupt

BETTER HABIT

If she can wait until she's at a desk, wait. Phone submission is the exception, not the routine.

SHEET 17A The same form at phone width.

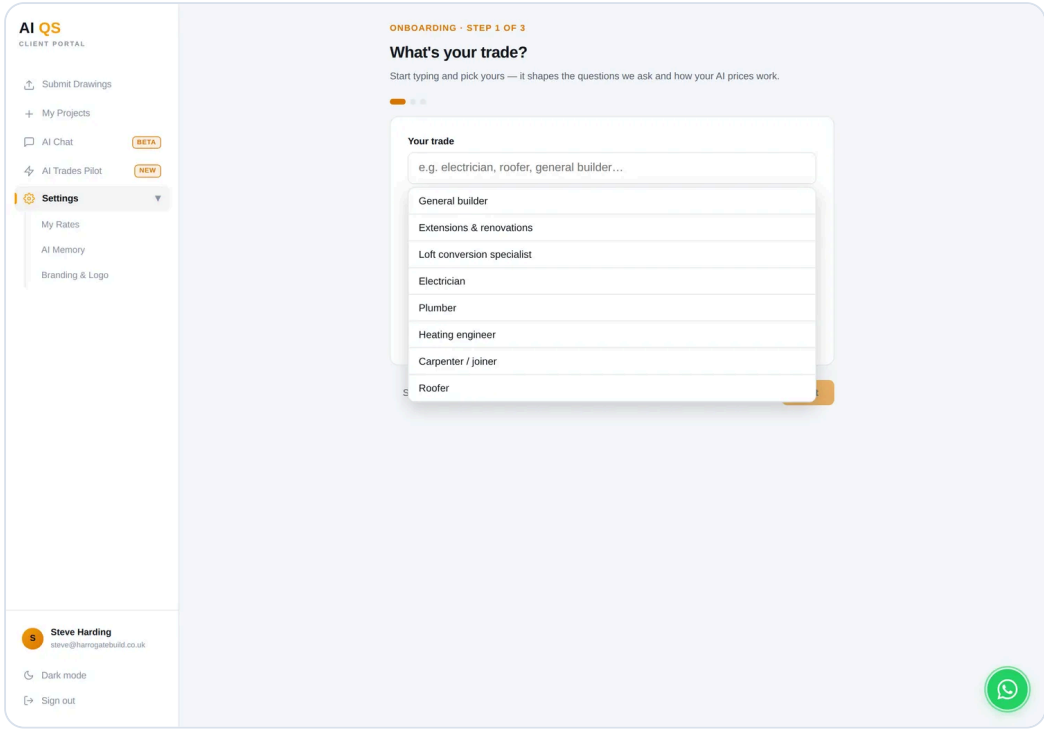
Tracking it in My Projects

Second item in the sidebar. Every job she's ever sent is here with its current state, newest first, and the counters across the top give the shape of the day at a glance.

- ✓ **In Queue** — submitted or in review, nothing to do yet
- ✓ **In Progress** — actively being priced
- ✓ **Completed** — priced and delivered, downloads waiting

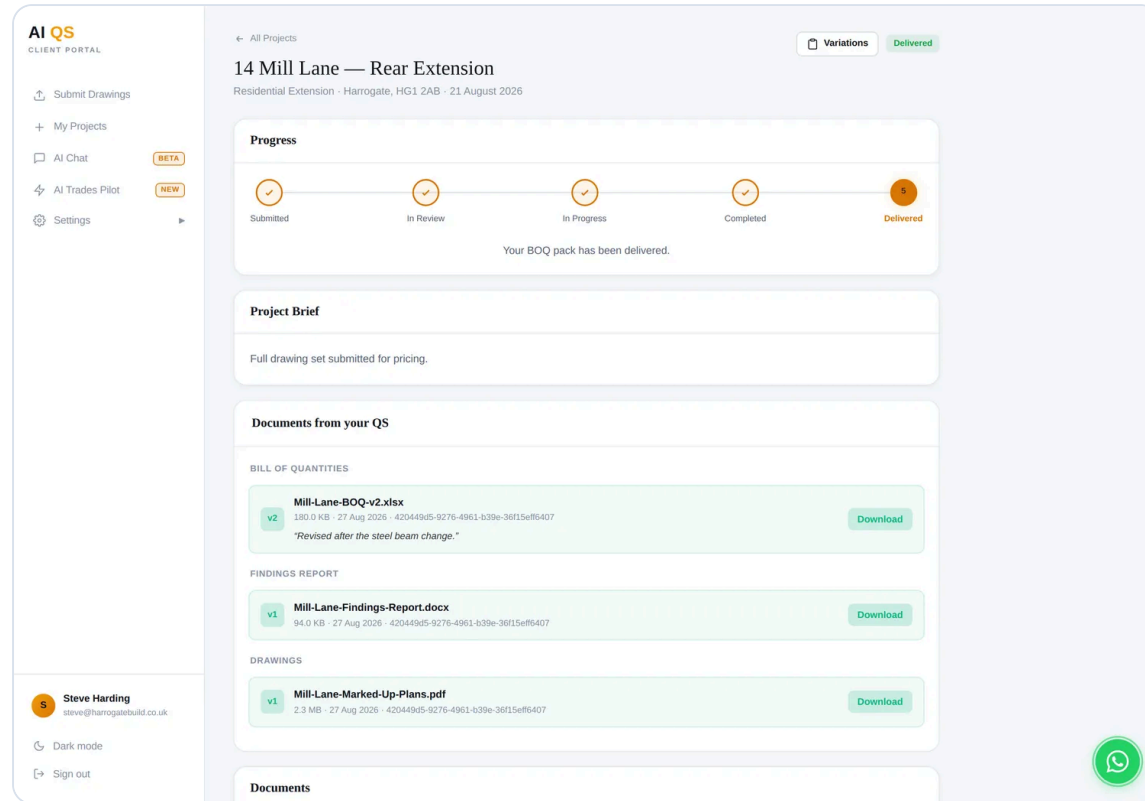
THE ONE RULE FOR CHASING

Turnaround is **typically within 24 hours**. Nothing needs chasing before then, and a job sent late on a Friday may reasonably land Monday. If a job is still *Submitted* after a full working day, that's the point to ask.



SHEET 18A Four jobs across four different states — this is the screen she should check first each morning.

Collecting the finished pack



SHEET 19A A delivered job. The tracker is full, and **Documents from your QS** holds the pack.

BILL OF QUANTITIES

The priced XLSX. This is the working document — amend the numbers here, then generate the Client Copy with your branding on it.

FINDINGS REPORT

The DOCX explaining what the surveyor found, assumed and excluded. **Read this before you quote** — the caveats live here, not in the spreadsheet.

VERSIONS MATTER

Documents are versioned, not overwritten. A green **v2** means it was revised — check the note beside it and make sure you're working from the latest.

Credits, and running out of them

One BOQ credit per submitted job, taken at the moment of sending. Credits never expire. A failed submission doesn't charge — the credit is only spent once the job is safely recorded.

PACK	PRICE	PER BOQ
5 BOQs	£349	£69.80
10 BOQs	£580	£58.00
20 BOQs	£980	£49.00

Prices as shown in the portal's top-up panel at the time of writing — the panel is always the authority.

DECIDE THIS NOW, NOT AT ZERO

Your VA is spending your money every time she sends a job. Agree the rule up front: either she tops up herself when the balance hits a set number, or she stops and asks you. Write the answer on her copy of this workbook.

What she'll see at zero

The banner turns red, **Submit Enquiry** stops working, and the top-up panel opens by itself with the three packs above. Nothing is lost — the form keeps what she typed while she sorts it out.

Where to check the balance

The banner at the top of Submit Drawings, every time. It also names how many jobs have been used, which is a quick sanity check against your own records.

Rates and branding

My Rates

Under **Settings** → **My Rates**. Every account starts on the standard library; the moment your own labour and material rates are in, the pricing starts sounding like your business instead of an average one.

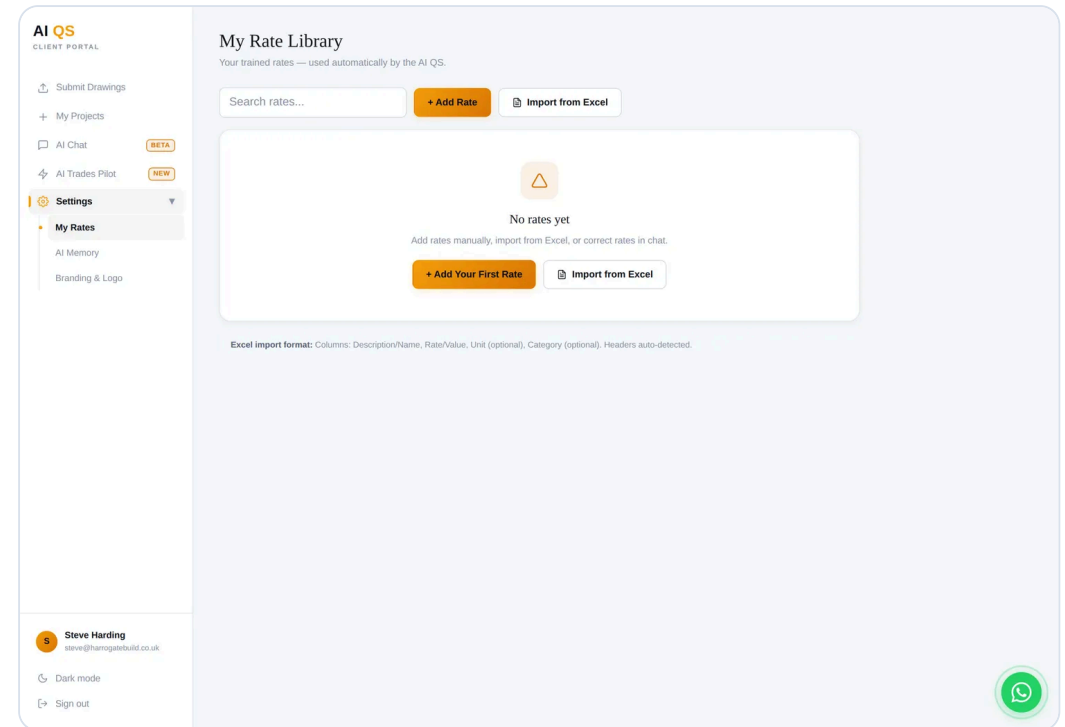
Good first task for a new VA: work through a recent priced job with you and load your real rates in. It pays back on every job after.

Branding & Logo

Under **Settings** → **Branding & Logo**. Your logo, brand colours and a document template. It's applied automatically to every Client Copy and Findings document, so the pack you forward to a client looks like it came from you.

SET IT ONCE

Both are account-level, so anything she sets up applies to every job from then on — including the ones you submit yourself.



SHEET 21A The rate library behind every price the portal produces for you.

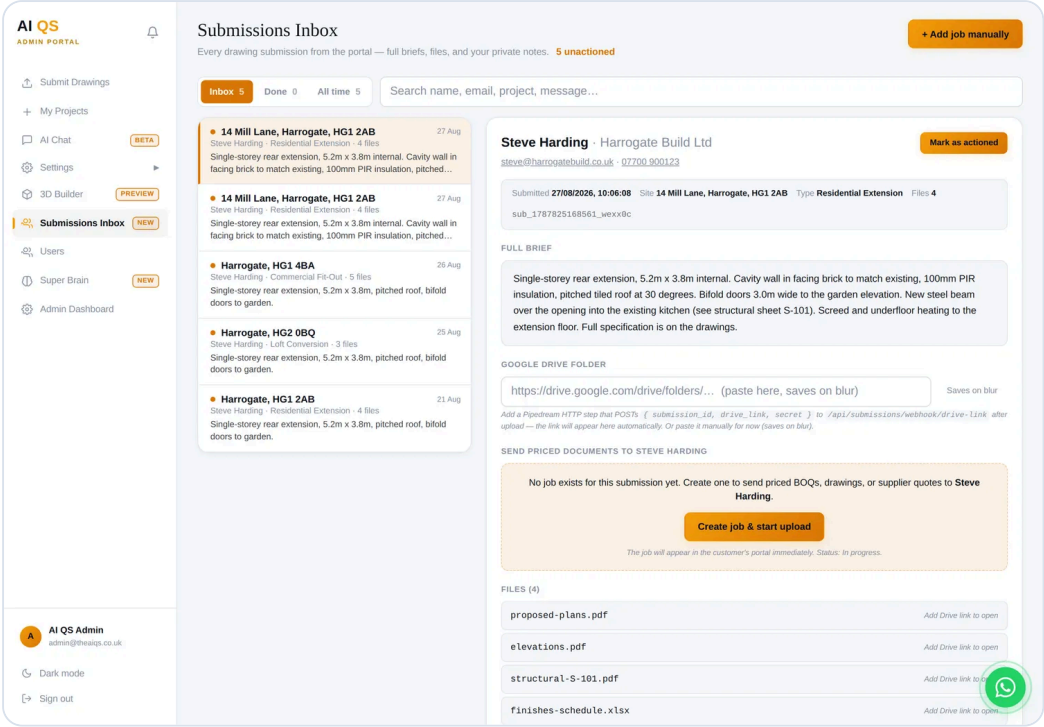
What the QS team sees

Worth knowing so you can answer her questions with confidence. Every submission arrives in the admin **Submissions Inbox** as a row: who sent it, the project type, the site address, the file count and the brief.

- ✓ Nothing is lost if the outbound forward fails — the files are kept and the job still lands in the inbox
- ✓ An admin turns a submission into a tracked job, then uploads the priced documents against it
- ✓ That upload is what flips the job to **Delivered** in your My Projects

SO WHEN SHE ASKS “DID IT ARRIVE?”

If she saw a green confirmation with a Submission ID, it arrived. The ID is the proof.



SHEET 22A The admin-side inbox — the other end of the belt.

Troubleshooting

WHAT SHE SEES	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT TO DO
“Invalid email or password”	She’s using her own email but hasn’t set a password yet, or the invite was never accepted.	Admin opens the panel on sheet 06 and clicks Resend invite . Or she uses Sign in with Google if it’s a Google address.
“This invite link has expired”	More than 7 days passed since the invite was issued.	Resend invite . The new link works, the old one is dead.
Submit Enquiry stays greyed out	Something required is missing.	Check all four: project type, site address, at least one file, 20+ characters of brief — and the Terms tick.
Red banner: 0 BOQ credits	The account is out of credits.	Top up from the panel that opens, or follow whatever rule you agreed on sheet 20.
“Submission failed — please try again”	The send didn’t complete. No credit has been charged.	Try once more. If it fails again, drop the largest file, send the rest, and email the remainder quoting the new Submission ID.
Upload sits there for minutes	Large files on a slow connection — normal, not stuck.	Leave the tab alone. Closing it kills the upload. Check the file sizes are under 100 MB each.
Still “Submitted” after a day	Past the usual turnaround.	Contact AI QS with the Submission ID. Don’t re-submit — that spends a second credit and creates a duplicate.
Sidebar shows the owner’s name	Nothing is wrong. She’s operating your account.	Nothing. See sheet 08.

Her one-page routine

EVERY SUBMISSION — IN ORDER

- 01 Check the credit banner**
Enough left? If not, stop and follow the top-up rule.
- 02 Project type**
Closest match. Unsure → Other, and say so in the brief.
- 03 Site address with postcode**
The works address, not the office.
- 04 All the drawings, one go**
PDF where possible. Check the file list before sending.
- 05 Write the brief properly**
Sizes, materials, awkward bits. Polish with AI after, never instead.
- 06 Tick Terms → Submit Enquiry**
Then leave the tab alone until the green banner appears.
- 07 Save the Submission ID**
Straight into the job sheet. Every time.

EACH MORNING

- ✓ Open **My Projects** and scan the three counters
- ✓ Download anything newly **Delivered** and file it against the job
- ✓ Flag anything still *Submitted* after a full working day

NEVER

- ✗ Re-submit a job that's already showing in My Projects
- ✗ Send a plan on its own when elevations and sections exist
- ✗ Close the tab mid-upload
- ✗ Send a client the BOQ without reading the Findings Report

FILL THESE IN BEFORE HANDING IT OVER

Her sign-in email · the top-up rule · who to contact at AI QS · where Submission IDs get logged.